SEAT BELT BUCKLE INSPECTION AND REPLACEMENT

AFFECTED VEHICLES: **CERTAIN 2000 MODEL YEAR CONTOUR, ESCORT/ZX2, TOWN CAR, EXPLORER/MOUNTAINEER, F-SERIES (LIGHT DUTY), RANGER, VILLAGER AND WINDSTAR (EUROPE ONLY)**

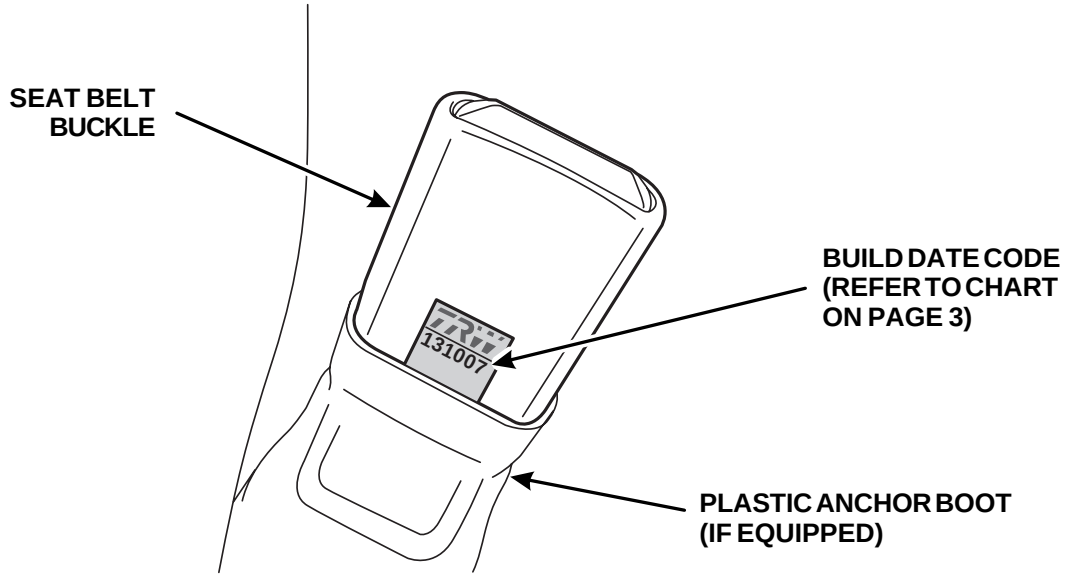
OVERVIEW

The affected vehicles in this program will require inspection of seat belt buckles in certain seating positions to determine if replacement is necessary.

- Not all seat belt buckles will require inspection. Only the seat belts identified in the Build Date Code Inspection chart will need to be inspected.
- The build date code is located on the seat belt buckle end. A plastic anchor boot covers the build date code on some affected seat belt buckles. These vehicles will require removal and disassembly of the seat belt buckle, and are identified in the Build Date Code Inspection chart.

SERVICE PROCEDURE

1. Refer to the Build Date Code Inspection chart on page 3 to identify the seat belt buckle(s) that require inspection.
2. Inspect the build date code located on the seat belt buckle end(s). Refer to Figure 1. If the build date code is covered by the plastic anchor boot, proceed as follows:
   - Remove the seat belt buckle from the vehicle. Refer to the service procedures in section 501-20A of the appropriate Workshop Manual.
   - Separate the seat belt buckle from the plastic anchor boot to access the build date code. If the plastic anchor boot is damaged during separation, replace the seat belt buckle assembly regardless of the build date code.



TYPICAL AFFECTED SEAT BELT BUCKLE

00S21A

FIGURE 1

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3. Compare the seat belt buckle date code to the code listed in the Build Date Code Inspection chart on Page 3.

   NOTE: On certain vehicles, you will receive a retractor and buckle as an assembly. Only the buckle is to be replaced under this program. The retractor portion of the ***new*** assembly should be discarded.

   NOTE: Apply Ford Threadlock 262 (E2FZ-19554B) or equivalent to fasteners when installing seat belt buckle assemblies.

   - If the build date code matches that listed in the chart, replace the seat belt buckle assembly. Refer to the service procedures in section 501-20A of the appropriate Workshop Manual.
   - If the build date code does not match those listed in the chart, the seat belt buckle does not require replacement. Assemble and install the seat belt buckle, if removed. Refer to the service procedures in section 501-20A of the appropriate Workshop Manual.

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BUILD DATE CODE INSPECTION CHART

Vehicle	Seat Location	Replace if this Build Date Code is on Buckle
CONTOUR/ MYSTIQUE	1st Row RH	157001 162002
ESCORT	2nd Row LH	163001
ZX2	2nd Row LH	163001
EXPLORER/ MOUNTAINEER	1st Row RH 1st Row LH	156001 161001 161002 163001
F-SERIES/ (LIGHT DUTY)	1st Row RH (60/40) 1st Row RH & LH (Full Bench)	131001 131007 151001
RANGER	1st Row RH	157002 161001 161002 163001 163002 164002 164003
TOWN CAR	2nd Row LH 2nd Row RH	131001 146001 146002 151001 156001 161000 161001
VILLAGER	1st Row RH 2nd Row RH (Bucket) 2nd Row (Bench) 3rd Row LH (Bench)	156001 157001
WINDSTAR (European Only)	1st Row RH 1st Row LH	137001 135002

Vehicles that require seat belt buckle removal prior to inspection

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